



Nokia 3230



Following the success of its hugely popular 6600, Nokia introduces another great smart phone for the masses—the 3230. Features abound and the 3230 is sensibly priced to appeal to the average buyer.

Designed in the traditional candy bar form factor, the 3230 is reasonably compact; though the styling does mess up ergonomically.

The keypad is set far away from the top of the screen and feels a little cramped. The navigational buttons are just too hard and have deep travel making them uncomfortable to work with—till you get used to them. Moreover, the silver buttons with a white backlight make reading them hard—an oversight. But the 3230 is equipped with a nimble joystick that offers slick movements.

Moving on, the 65K colour screen as usual is brilliant. The screen does fade out in outdoor settings, but legibility is not affected.

On the back panel, right at the top is the 1.3 mp camera that takes amazing photographs. The Nokia 3230 also

allows shooting an hour-long video with the ability to edit the video on the device itself.

The 3230 supports loads of features: it is tri-band ready and supports GPRS and EDGE, enough for some fast data transfer.

Short range communication is via Bluetooth and USB via pop port. Multimedia capabilities include an MP3 player, FM receiver and Real Player. The games provided with 3230 are good and offer unlimited fun!

Nokia 3230 comes with a 32MB RS MMC card. But it is placed under the battery cover and isn't truly hot-swappable.

The UI on this phone isn't sluggish and feels great to use. Nokia has offered the usual set of applications, and they work great. PIM, messaging and e-mail works without any hiccups, but we will be glad to see some better synchronising capabilities in the future.

The Nokia 3230 retails for Rs 15,000 in India. It is a good entry-level smart phone for the 1.3 mp camera, great display and feature-rich application bundle. But remember the keypad issues before you buy it.



Sagem MyX-8

The MyX-8 from Sagem, is their top-of-the-line model combining good aesthetics with loads of features.

Designed by Ora-ito for Sagem, the combination of brushed aluminium and milky white plastic gives it an Apple-ish feel. The candy bar form factor measuring 115 x 47 x 20 mm and weighing 125 gm does not feel light or compact.

The front of the phone is dominated by the overly large TFT display. This 256K colour display offers the best in class resolution of 240 x 320. High resolution means cleaner graphics and that's evident!

The white backlit keypad has small, elongated keys that are well spaced out but are hard to press. The small joystick is too recessed and defeats the very purpose of having it all together.

The 1.3 mp camera with 8X digital zoom is located on the back and has a shoddy user interface. Video recording is also available, but is accessible from a different menu.

Audio is probably the strongest point of this phone. The inbuilt

speaker is so loud that people in the Digit office mistook it for multimedia speakers!

MP3 and AAC files can be played on it, and to store these songs, the MyX-8 is provided with a RS-MMC slot, which is awkwardly positioned at the base of the cell phone. Though hot swappable, you still need to remove the battery cover to access it, which is pointless.

The nice graphical user interface is decorated with smart looking colourful icons. However the grouping of menus, can do with loads of improvement. Standard applications such as contact manager, calendar, etc., comes bundled with the phone.

The MyX-8 is a tri-band phone and supports GPRS but not EDGE.

For short range communication it has Bluetooth, IR and USB connectivity. Other features include 40 MB shared memory, Java 2.0 support, 64 channel polyphonic ring tones and a media player.

MyX-8 retails for around Rs 18,000, but we would advice you to wait till the MyX-9 if it is ever released.

